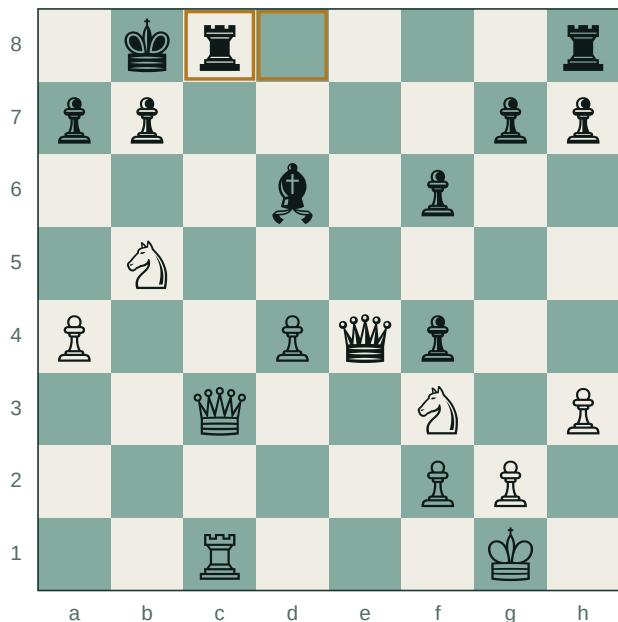


Attraction tactics: White, move 25

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 24...Rc8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. Qxc8+ Rxc8 26. Rxc8+ Kxc8 27. Nxd6+ Kd7 28. Nxe4

25.Qxc8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From c8 it attacks king on b8 and rook on h8. Recorded reply: **25...Rxc8**.

26.Rxc8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on c8. Recorded reply: **26...Kxc8**.

27.Nxd6+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From d6 it attacks king on c8 and queen on e4. Recorded reply: **27...Kd7**.

28.Nxe4 The knight captures the queen on e4.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from -3 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on b8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d6 and queen on e4. Check for tactical protection.